

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

One of the perks of travelling alone in a foreign country is the happy obscurity it affords. There is neither the tug of a family nor the social pressures of friends and rivals to influence one's immediate thoughts. On the flip side, such solitudinal travels reveal, in moments of weariness, the loneliness that modern societies can easily thrust on individuals, despite the grope and throb of megacities. More fundamentally, travelling can reveal to an individual how dependent we are on our immediate relations to discern the structure of social reality. The world - the traveller realises - perpetually presents itself as a garden of forking paths and to choose wisely, without the benefit of experience and tradition is perilous. To get away from one's fold is dangerous, not just for one's bodily safety but also for one's mind, trapped as it can get in a wilderness of foreign mirrors.

- ☐ a) Eventually, when modernity cranked up its production of the disaffected and disconnected, there arose an effort to valorise the individual itself.
- ☐ b) Man, to this day, waddles afloat between the deep waters of nostalgia below and the sun-drenched future above.
- ☒ c) However, in this very danger also lies hidden the possibility of self-discovery. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) However, closer to our times, travel has lost its frisson - much of the world has become safer and many of travel's historic roles have been usurped by specialisations.

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

There is evidence that musicians and conductors of orchestras live longer and are more contented. Music is the language of the soul and crosses all barriers of nations, religion, ethnicity, language, culture and tradition. No wonder music unites all living organisms. One has to cultivate the art of listening to music in nature. The song of the birds, the music of insects, amphibians, whales, elephants, thunder and lightning, creating melodious sounds from Aeolian harps, the sound of rain, winds and hurricanes are all the familiar examples of music in nature. Some composers and musicians have gone out of the way to create soothing sounds reproduced from nature especially from the flow of water and sea waves. An evening musical concert is a most peaceful and enjoyable form of entertainment. Many surgeons use western classical music, operas and contemporary rock during surgical procedures. Their personal preferences of music vary a lot to suit their age and choice.

☐ a) Everyone became aware of and learnt different types of music, appreciated or acquired gadgets to listen at other times as well

☐ b) One thing that was common to all these locations was the profound effect it has on the staff present in the theatre. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) Doctors permit and prescribe music therapy for such patients.

☒ d) There was little or no anxiety, no frayed tempers and no lack of concentration. (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

The paragraph speaks about the profound effect that music has on the human mind and how it is the language of the soul which transcends all barriers of nations, religion, ethnicity, language, culture and tradition. It also elaborates on how many surgeons, use western classical music, operas and contemporary rock, during surgical procedures. And, depending on their age and preference they choose their music. Since the last two sentences deal with music being played by surgeons while they are doing their procedures, it would therefore, be appropriate to choose option B as the concluding sentence for the paragraph because it tells the reader about the effect that music has on the staff in the theatre (the operation theatre, in this context) which, is obviously the continuation of the context given in the last line.

Option A cannot be the concluding sentence for the paragraph because it portrays no connection to the context of the paragraph so it is irrelevant and cannot be used as the concluding sentence.

Option C speaks about doctors permitting and prescribing music therapy for such patients which again, bears no relevance to the context of the paragraph so, it cannot be used as the concluding sentence.

Option D has no connection to the paragraph or to the last sentence of the paragraph and therefore cannot be used as the concluding sentence. However, it could be a successor to option B.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

What is so special about the Ganga? There are rivers that are much longer, wider, larger, than the Ganga on this planet - the Brahmaputra, the Amazon, the Nile and the Hwang Ho. There is something unique about the Ganga that is not found in any of these great rivers: despite all the pollutants being pumped into the Ganga, it has somehow managed to maintain its relative purity. Chemically, it contains extraordinary properties - its water does not putrefy or deteriorate even if kept bottled for long, unlike the water from other rivers. It is interesting to know that the water of the Ganga has properties different from those of other rivers but which seem to undergo a mystical change once they flow into the Ganga's waters.

- ☒ a) This is a mystery that even science has not been able to understand, as yet. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ b) Thousands of people attaining the highest stage of life have lived near the Ganga.
- ☐ c) For millions of years, sages sought out God on the banks of the Ganga.
- ☐ d) All these people who have undertaken a spiritual journey to this great river and sat on her banks, meditating, have left their life-energy on the banks of the Ganga.

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a letter. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} He had also said the greatest mistake that the United States made in Iraq was to allow the government in Baghdad to retain control over the country's oil.
- ^{2.} Trump was constantly railing against China over issues ranging from trade to the South China Sea.
- ^{3.} On the campaign trail, Donald Trump had promised to be a true friend of Israel and scrap the nuclear deal with Iran.
- ^{4.} However, it was his stance on immigration, particularly his pledge to stop Muslims from entering the U.S. and the promise to build a "great wall" along the long border with Mexico, which galvanised his voter base and, at the same time, turned world public opinion against him.
- ^{5.} Now he is even threatening to oppose China's "One China" policy.

Solution:

Within a short span of gaining power, the Trump administration escalated tensions, political, economic and military, all over the world.

Sequentially, it makes sense to place sentence (3) first for the reason that it speaks of Donald Trump's promises during the election campaign. Sentence (1) is next as it states an opinion he expressed during the campaign. Sentence (2) follows. (5), which continues to tell about Trump's stand on China, notwithstanding all these, it was his stance on immigration and the promise to build a "great wall" along the border with Mexico that shocked many [Sentence (4)]. Thus, the proper sequence of the sentences is 3, 1, 2, 5, 4

Ans : (31254)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a letter. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. And as traditions go, the time has come for khadi to reinvent.
2. Under the veil of simplicity, the versatile fabric has for long carried the weight of balancing traditions and style.
3. Political freedom then and freedom of spirit now, through every phase of its growth, khadi has been more than just a piece of fabric.
4. If one traces the life and journey of khadi - the crown jewel of Indian traditional fabrics - the one sentiment it triumphantly conjures up for every Indian is that of freedom.
5. The government's initiative to promote khadi, along with Indian fashion houses' interest to take the agenda forward with their prowess of design and scale, has set a grand stage for the resurgence of brand Khadi.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about 'khadi', the crown jewel of Indian traditional fabrics. The starter would be choice 4 talking about the one sentiment that khadi conjures up for every Indian — freedom. Choice 3, which explains how khadi has been a symbol of the freedom of spirit, carries forward the idea. Choice 2 follows 4 stating how this versatile fabric has been a blend of tradition and style. Choice 1 is next saying that the time has come to reinvent khadi. Choice 5 sums up with the government's initiative to promote khadi on a grand scale. Thus 4, 3, 2, 1, 5 is the right order of sentences to form a paragraph.

Ans : (43215)

Directions for questions 4 to 6: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a letter. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. However, it has maintained that the Dalai Lama's visit was purely for religious reasons; it is also not the first time he has visited the state - he made official trips there in 1983, 1997, twice in 2003 and in 2009.
2. The Tibetan spiritual leader, 81, had visited Arunachal Pradesh in India's remote north-east earlier in April.
3. China had said the visit had a "negative impact" on bilateral relations and warned India against "undermining" Beijing's interests.
4. India has not yet commented on the Chinese announcement, made recently.
5. China has renamed six districts along a disputed Himalayan border region with India, in a move seen as "retaliation" for a visit by the Dalai Lama.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about China renaming its six districts in the disputed Himalayan border region with India. Choice 5 is the starter with this statement with the renaming move seen as a retaliation for a visit by the Dalai Lama. Choice 2 which talks about Dalai Lama's visit to Arunachal Pradesh, comes next. Choice 3 follows with China stating that the Dalai Lama's visit will have a negative impact on the Indo-China bilateral relations. Choice 4 follows stating that India's still silent on the issue. Choice 1 sums up with India maintaining that the Dalai Lama's visit was for purely religious reasons. Thus 5, 2, 3, 4, 1 is the logical sequence of sentences which form a paragraph.

Ans : (52341)

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. In the run-up to sakura, a televised Cherry Blossom Forecast offers a petal-by-petal analysis of the advance of the blooms as they ripple from the south to the north like a pink and white Mexican wave.
2. During peak flowering time, which lasts from a week to 10 days, the nation engages in a frenzy of blossom appreciation with the kind of ardor that other countries reserve for sporting events or religious festivals.
3. "Between our two lives there is also the life of the cherry blossom."-Matsuo Basho
4. Cherry blossoms or sakura, the flowers that have launched a thousand haikus, are in full bloom in Japan.

Your Answer: 3 

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} Rather, what it demands is the ruthless suppression of all resistance and systematic gagging of all protest, which requires nothing less than an obsession with power that borders on psychosis.
- ^{2.} The institutional contexts for both matrilineal and modern-feminine power have disappeared from Kerala, and the transformation of higher education into a lawless, near-criminal, greed-driven profit-making sector has ensured that the latter has no relevance at all.
- ^{3.} Anthropologists who have studied Nair matrilineality often note that it was very hard to make generalizations about it; practices seemed to change from family to family.
- ^{4.} But such tyrants are psychologically weak; they hang on till the bitter end, and simply cannot bring themselves to avert an impending disaster.

Solution:

The passage is about the matrilineal system followed by certain communities in Kerala and the modern feminine power. The ideal beginning would be choice 2 which talks about how these have disappeared from Kerala and how education has been totally commercialized. Choice 1 follows saying that this higher education is only an obsession with power. Choice 4 sums up saying that such power tyrants are psychologically weak and cannot avert impending disasters. Thus 2, 1, 4 forms a logical sequence of the statements and choice 3 which discusses a study by the Anthropologists is the odd one out.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 9 and 10: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

The suit alleges that US leaders are not doing enough to _____ climate change and are failing to protect essential "public trust" resources such as clean air and water, thereby _____ future generations of their constitutional rights to life, liberty and property.

- ☐ a) halt encouraging
- ☐ b) avert. . . . stopping
- ☐ c) curtail. . . . discouraging

☒ d) curb. . . . depriving (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 9 and 10: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Vision deterioration in astronauts is likely owing to the _____ of a day-night cycle in intra- cranial pressure, say scientists, adding that using a vacuum device to lower pressure for part of each day might _____ the problem.

- ☐ a) lack. . . . prevent

☒ b) absence. . . . renew (Your answer - ✗)

- ☐ c) back. . . . reflect
- ☐ d) slack reduce

Solution:

The sentence is about vision deterioration in astronauts, the reason for it and the remedy for prevention of the problem. Astronauts are mostly in space and do not have a day-night cycle as they are in space. Hence, 'back' and 'slack' in choices C and D respectively are out of context and can be rejected. The word 'renew' is not logical in the second blank. 'Lack' in choice A is a perfect synonym for 'do not have' and 'prevent' fits perfectly in the second blank. Hence choice A is the right answer.

Choice (A)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

When Amazon, the online retail giant, decided to open a brick-and-mortar store, some thought it was a regression of sorts. However, it soon became evident that the company was not turning the clock back at all. Instead, it was taking a big leap into the future by setting up a grocery store where there would be no cash registers or checkout lines to waste time. Called Amazon Go, and due to open in the US early next year, these stores will allow customers to walk in and pick up whatever they want. However, unlike in giant superstore chains like Walmart, shoppers in Amazon Go stores will have access to a specially created app - one that allows you to scan products, then walk into the shop and pick up what you want. The app will automatically debit your account when you walk out of the store and e-mail you the bill.

- ^{1.} By deciding to start retail grocery stores that will have no cash registers or checkout lines, Amazon, the online retail giant, is “reinventing shoplifting”.
- ^{2.} A specially created app meant for people visiting Amazon Go stores that are being opened soon, will allow them to scan products, walk into the shop devoid of cash counters, pick up whatever they want and get the bill amount automatically debited from their account at the point of exit.
- ^{3.} Amazon, the online retail giant, is taking a big leap into the future by setting up app-oriented grocery stores where there would be no cash registers or checkout lines to waste time.
- ^{4.} Amazon Go, the grocery shops being opened by the online retail giant, is bound to make shopping hassle-free and pleasurable because an app specially created for the purpose eliminates the need for billing counters.

Solution:

The main points are:

1. Amazon, the online retail giant, is opening grocery stores that will have no cash registers or checkout lines.
2. A specially created app will allow customers to scan products, then walk into the shop and pick up things.
3. The app will automatically debit the customer's account when he/she exits.

Option (1) speaks of the novelty being brought in by Amazon, but skips two of the main points. Option (2) presents the crux of the text in an appropriate manner. In option (3), it is not clear what the app will do. Points 2 and 3 are not covered in option (4).

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Robotics is beginning to revolutionise prosthetic arms and hands for the disabled. A month ago, Spanish scientists developed a robotic hand which was completely controlled by the mind, enabling people with spinal injuries to perform tasks like picking up a glass of water and drinking it. The prosthetic device did not require any implants or use of gels to transmit signals, which is the norm with many such brain-controlled robotic aids. There were still limitations, though, over the amount of freedom with which they could operate their arms. The arm would have something like 25 degrees of freedom of movement; to get a sense, bringing a glass of water to your mouth involves about seven degrees of movement.

1. As a breakthrough in the field of prosthetics, Spanish scientists have developed a robotic hand with about 25 degrees of freedom of movement.
2. Robotic aids which can be used to perform tasks via brain signals shall be of immense help to paraplegics, provided such aids have ample freedom of movement.
3. Proving that robotics is beginning to revolutionise prosthetic arms and hands for the disabled, Spanish scientists have developed a robotic hand completely controlled by the mind, with no requirement of implants or use of gels to transmit signals.
4. Though severe limitations exist on the freedom of movement of prosthetic arms and hands for the disabled, it is hoped that as the science of robotics grows, the degree of freedom that a prosthetic limb has to move will hopefully grow exponentially.

Solution:

The main points are:

1. Robotics is beginning to revolutionise prosthetic arms and hands for the disabled.
2. Spanish scientists have developed a robotic hand which is completely controlled by the mind, with no requirement of implants or use of gels to transmit signals.

Option (1) fails to state the important fact that the robotic hand developed in Spain is completely controlled by the brain. Options (2) and (4) are silent on point #2. Option (3) has both the points.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

The Arctic Sea ice is thawing at a rapid pace - over the past three decades, the area of sea ice in the Arctic has fallen by more than half. A recent report estimates that the Arctic will be free of ice by 2040, much before an earlier estimate of 2070. Melting of the Arctic ice has a direct correlation with the rising incidence of droughts, floods and heatwaves. The warming Arctic affects ocean currents and winds, with follow-on effects across the world, including on the Monsoon. This impacts cropping patterns and food production, and exacerbates water stresses. Apart from gearing up for effects such as an increase in extreme weather incidents and rising sea levels, countries including India, must reinforce their commitment to a lower carbon economy.

1. With the rate at which the Arctic Sea ice is thawing, the region will have no ice by the year 2040, a situation that is bound to have serious repercussions.
2. Realising the serious repercussions of the rapid melting of the Arctic Sea ice, countries need to reinforce their commitment to a lower carbon economy.
3. The quickened pace of sea ice melt in the Arctic region will mean rising sea levels that will pose a danger to coastal cities, including Mumbai.
4. The melting of the Arctic Sea ice, which has been an issue of concern for scientists and environmentalists for long, must now concern the larger community and countries around the world.

Solution:

The main points are:

1. The Arctic Sea ice is thawing at a rapid pace.
2. The repercussions will be calamitous.
3. Countries need to reinforce their commitment to a lower carbon economy.

Point 3 is not mentioned in options (1) and (3). Option (2) presents the essence in an appropriate way. Based on the contents of the passage, we are not sure whether the thawing of the Arctic Sea has been a matter of concern for scientists/ environmentalists (as stated in the last option)

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and the mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. Holmes first sprang to prominence with the publication of 'Old Ironsides', the ode that led to preservation of the battleship U.S.S. Constitution.
2. So it was, for one of the most highly regarded American poets of the 19th century, Oliver Wendell Holmes.
3. A poet's typical income being what it is, it helps if you are also a working physician.
4. The sketches, a showcase for his opinions and humor, were published in the Atlantic Monthly magazine and later collected into the book The Autocrat of the Breakfast Table.
5. He studied medicine in Paris, received his medical degree from Harvard, taught anatomy and physiology at Dartmouth college.

Solution:

The paragraph is about Oliver Wendell Holmes, the famous American poet who was also a physician. The ideal starter would be choice 3 which says, humorously, that it is better to be a poet-cum- physician to augment your income. Choice 2 follows saying that Oliver Wendell Holmes was one such poet. Next comes choice 1 talking about the literary work which made Holmes famous. Choice 5 sums up detailing his education and profession. Thus 3, 2, 1, 5 forms a logical sequence of the sentences and choice 4 which talks about some sketches published is the odd one out.

Ans : (4)

1. The wild haired wonder was no slouch when it came to putting pencil and paper to more traditional uses, too: namely, writing about the complexities of life in a way that we all can understand.
2. Before God we are all equally wise--- and equally foolish.
3. His intellectual tools were beyond compare, of course--- including a deep, intuitive understanding of the workings of nature combined with the so-called thought experiments that he used to develop theories.
4. There probably was not a more powerful thinker in the 20th century- or any century for that matter- than theoretical physicist Albert Einstein.
5. With physical tools no more complicated than the pencil and paper, he revolutionized the way that scientists think about time, space and matter.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the scientific genius Albert Einstein. The starter would be choice 4 introducing Albert Einstein as the most powerful thinker of the 20th century. Choice 5 follows with how Einstein had revolutionized scientific thinking with the simple pencil and paper. Next comes choice 3 talking about his intellectual tools. Choice 1 sums up saying that Einstein was a good writer too. Thus 4, 5, 3, 1 forms a logical sequence of the sentences while choice 2 which appears to be a philosophical musing is the odd one out.

Ans : (2)